Synthetic-media Discourse Analysis

Facilitator field guide

Notice. Discuss. Check. Reflect.

VERSION 1.7 REVIEW / 15 OCT 2026



A visual companion for community groups, workshop hosts and trainers. Use the four activities to explore how AI-generated and traditional media are made, compare different kinds of evidence and decide a practical next step.

The app brings Community Workshop, Developer and Facilitator guide together. Prepared examples open saved findings. These screenshots illustrate the workshop journey; the entered responses are examples for this guide.

An academic research project of **Synthetic Realities**, led by **Dr Sam Martin**, Smart Data Research UK (UKRI) Fellow (Grant number UKRI4010), Manchester Metropolitan University (MMU). ORCID: 0000-0002-4466-8374.

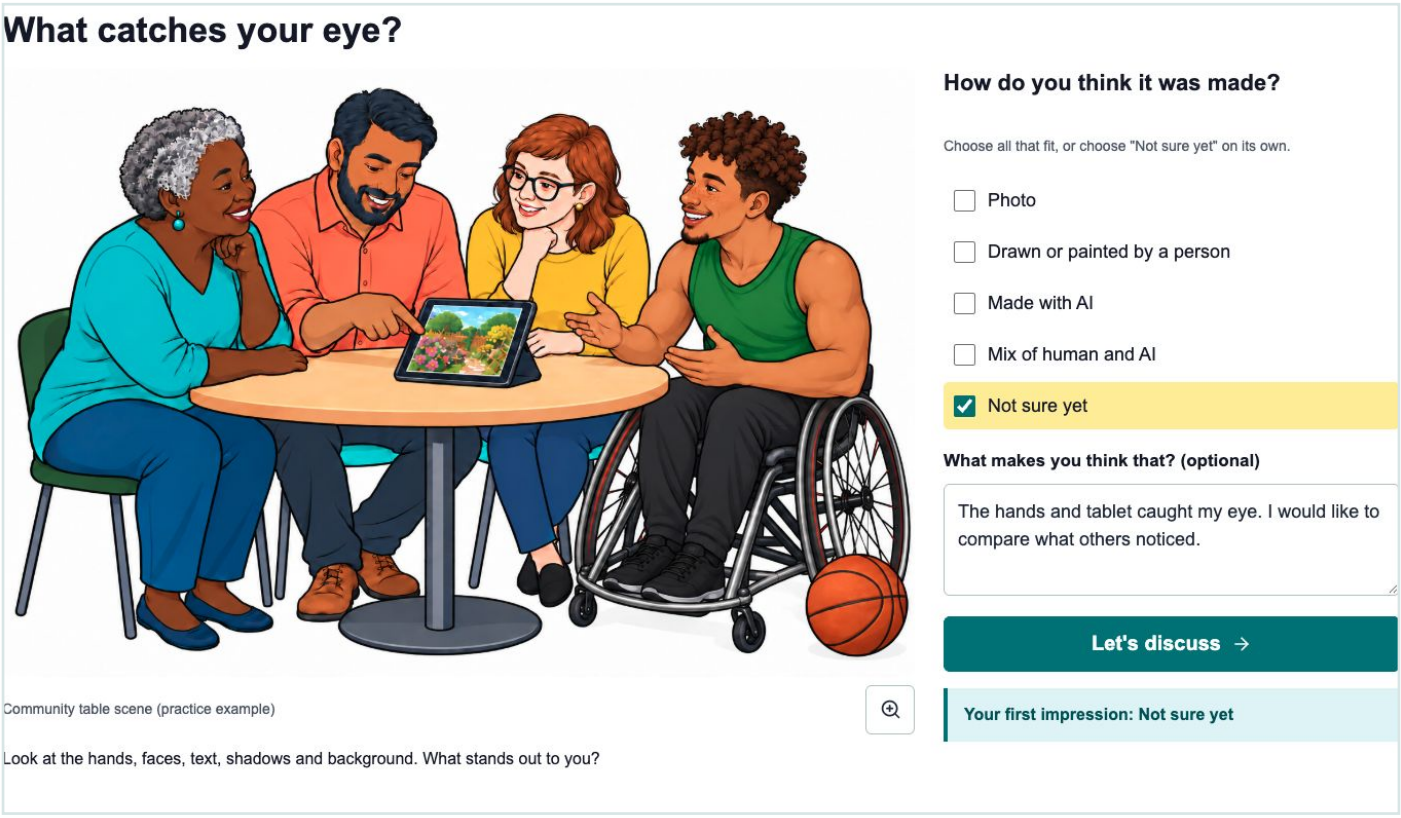
Project website: sdavision.io (published version may differ)

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY 1

1

Notice

Make room for first impressions.



Workshop activity - prepared example and sample responses.

Questions for the group

1 Did different details catch people's attention?

2 Would anyone like more time to look or listen?

3 Which first impressions would you like to explore together?

Invite a quiet moment to look or listen. People can select more than one impression, add a note, or choose “Not sure yet”.

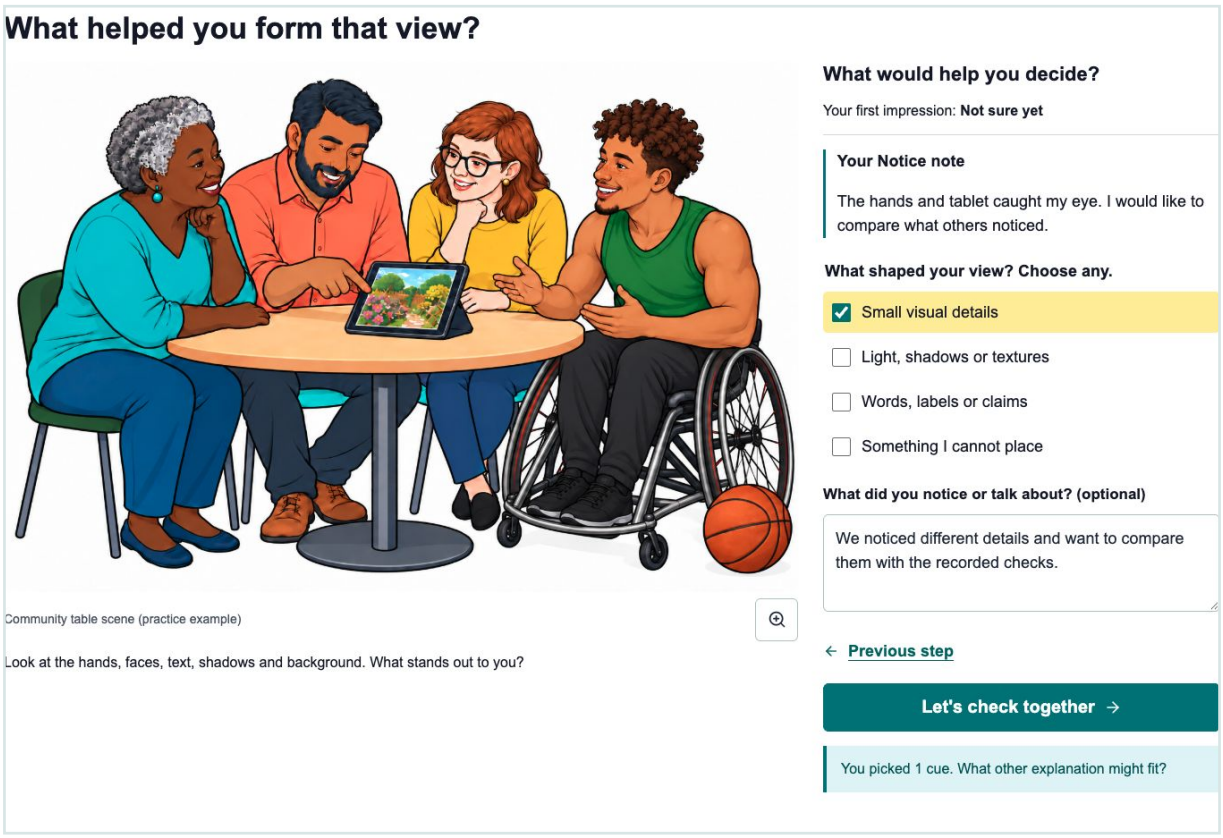
Start with the community table scene, labelled as a practice example. Its creation details appear at Check, after people have shared first impressions. The menu also offers other prepared media.

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY 2

2

Discuss

Explore the reasons behind a view.



Workshop activity - prepared example and sample responses.

Questions for the group

1 Did someone notice something different?

2 Can the same detail have more than one explanation?

3 What question would help the group move forward?

Invite people to point to a detail and explain why it matters. Compare explanations before opening the findings.

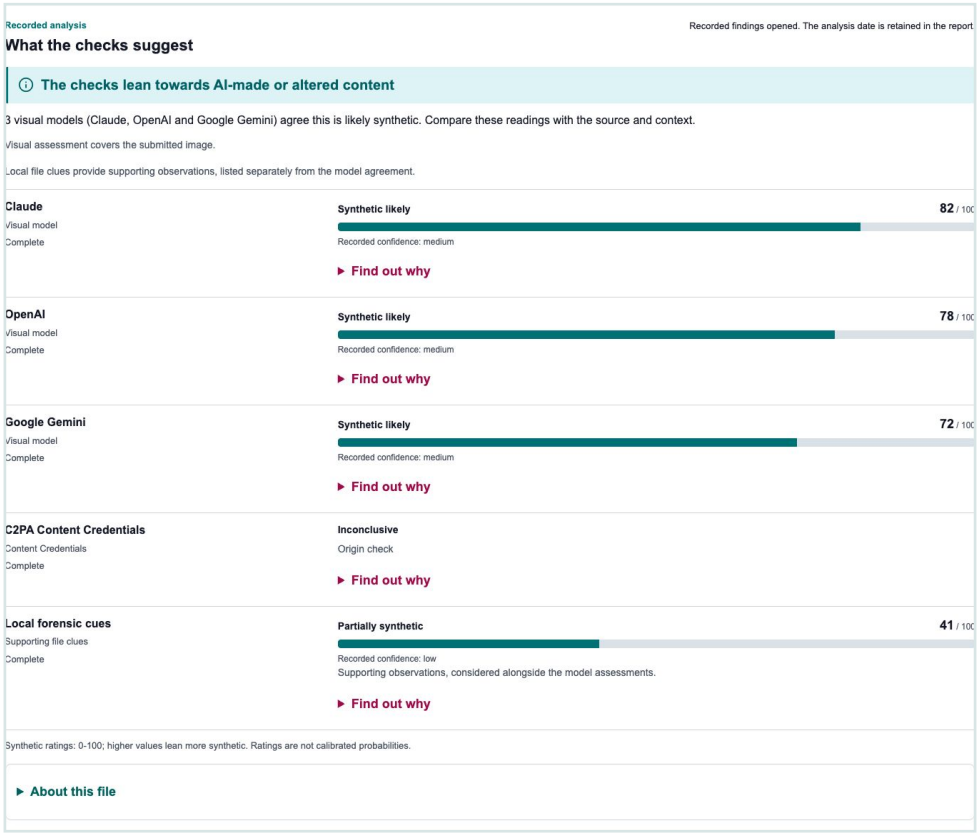
The Notice note appears here to support discussion. Use “Let’s check together” when the group is ready to open the saved findings. People can revisit earlier responses throughout the activity.

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY 3

3

Check

Connect each finding to its evidence.



Workshop activity - prepared example and sample responses.

Questions for the group

1 What did each check cover?

2 Which findings come from a file record, a model or a person's observation?

3 Where could the group look for the missing evidence?

Use “Let’s check together” in Discuss to open the saved findings. Compare their coverage with the group’s first impressions. Direct entry to Check offers “Open recorded findings”.

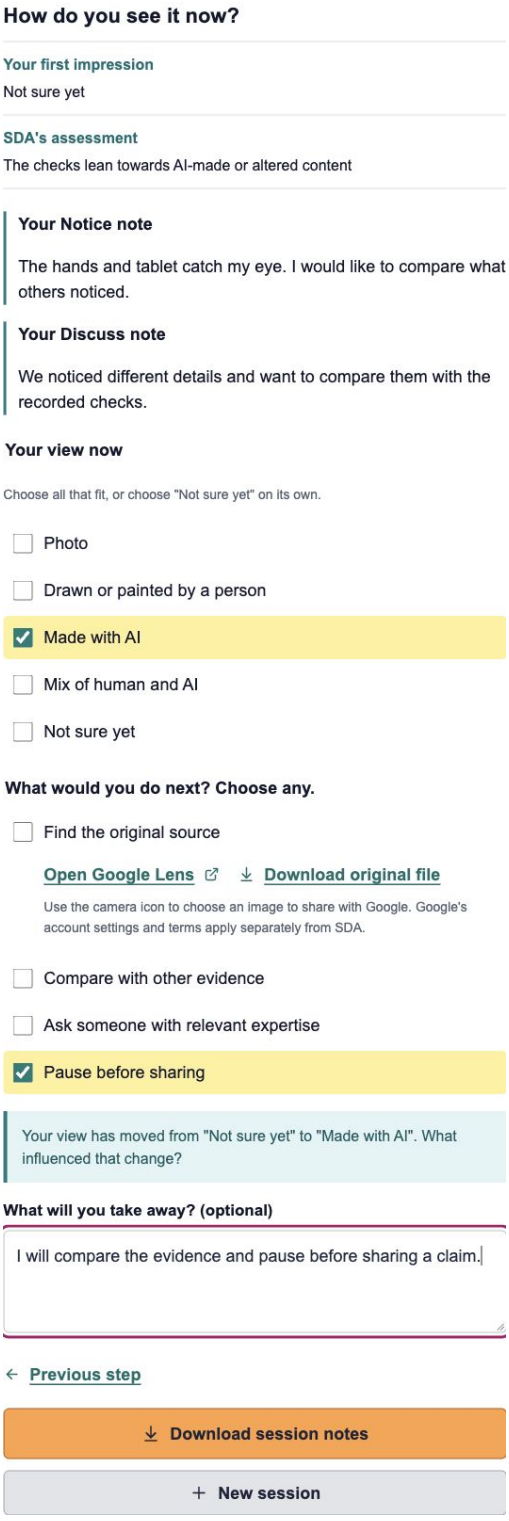
Expand “Find out why” beneath each reading. “About this file” below the table explains any creation label. For the podcast, distinguish transcript findings from the Sound tab’s short-excerpt description. Ratings are not calibrated probabilities.

WORKSHOP ACTIVITY 4

4

Reflect

Turn the discussion into a useful next step.



Questions for the group

1. What changed people's views, and what stayed uncertain?
2. Which next step feels practical in everyday life?
3. How would you explain the findings to someone else?

Guide the reflection

Revisit the Notice and Discuss notes. Invite a later view, a practical next action and an optional takeaway. A changed view and a remaining uncertainty can both contribute to the discussion.

Take the notes away

Choose PDF, PowerPoint or CSV, then “Download session notes”. Include workshop responses when wanted. SynthID and OpenAI pasted replies accompany the session downloads separately from the recorded findings. “New session” offers saving and an acknowledgement before clearing the page.

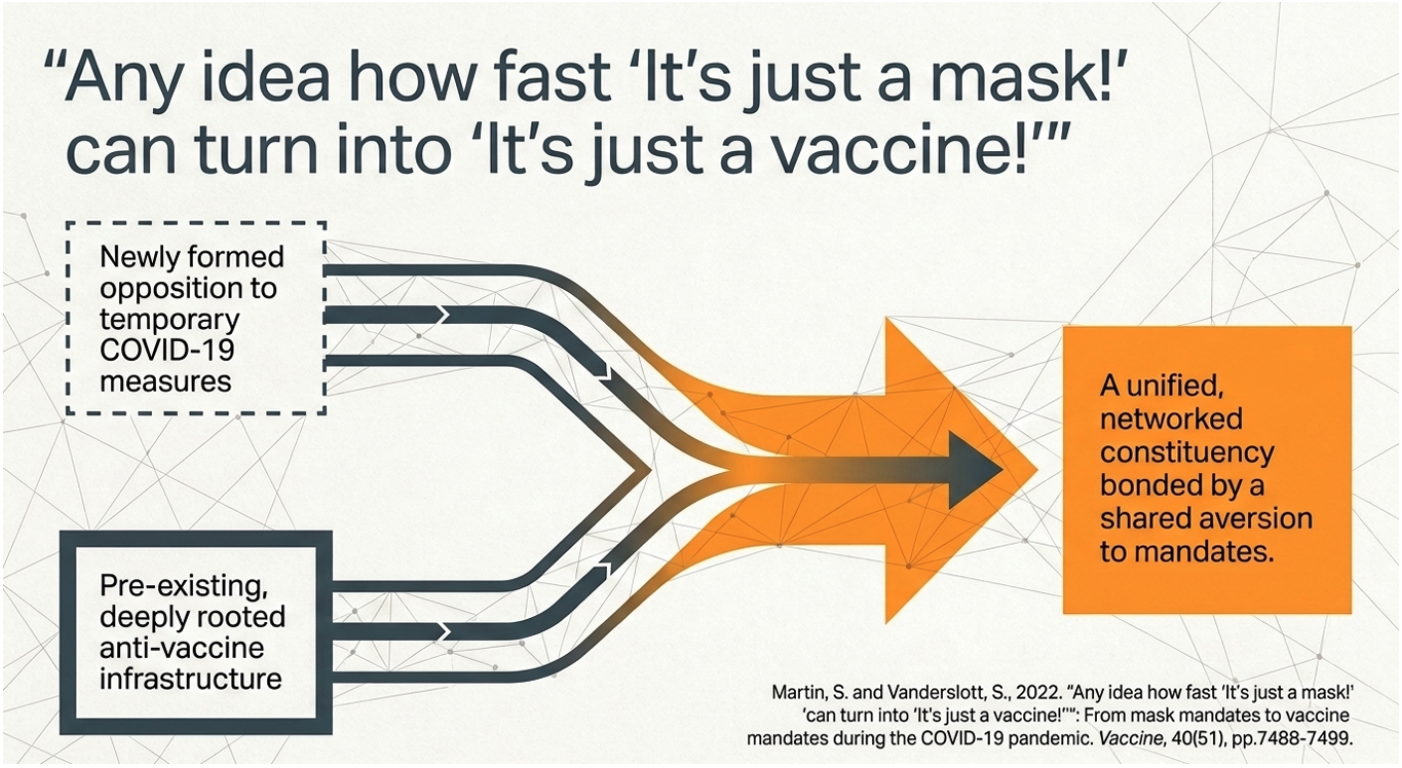
Example responses are shown. The saved model assessment retains its original scores and date.

PODCAST ACTIVITY

5

Follow the source

How was it made? What does it draw on? How faithfully does it represent that source?



Notice: Listen to a short section. What shapes your first impression of how this podcast was made?
Discuss: Take a closer look at the cover image. Which names, dates or references could help you trace its source?
Check: Search for a distinctive phrase from the title or the authors' names. Find the publication, then compare one podcast statement with the paper.
Reflect: What have you learned about the research and the podcast's production? How would you describe both when sharing it?

Search Google for the publication | **Read the research paper**

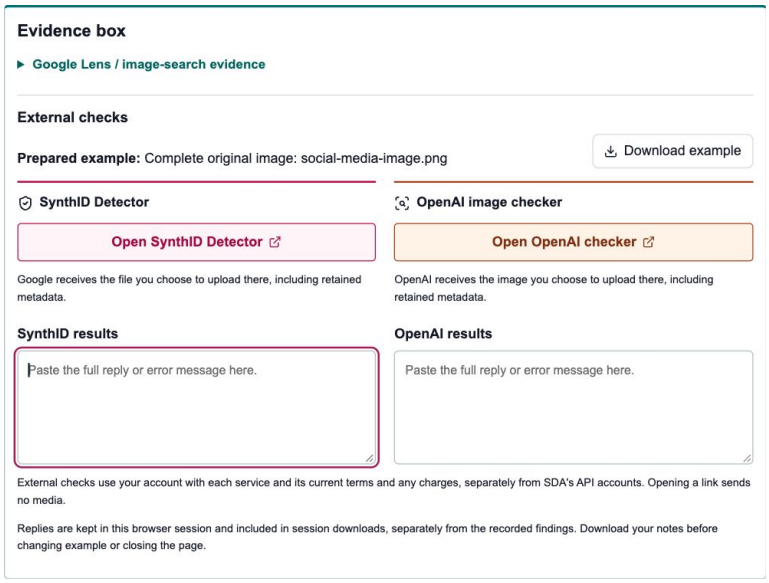
Final workshop verdict: Mix of human and AI

Human-authored research, selected by Dr Sam Martin and adapted into a podcast with Google NotebookLM. Following the cover citation and comparing a statement with the paper adds source evidence to human reflection. The saved ratings assess the transcript; the audio excerpt has a separate description. Together, these different kinds of evidence support a fuller understanding of the podcast.

Martin, S. and Vanderslott, S. (2022). From mask mandates to vaccine mandates during the COVID-19 pandemic. Vaccine, 40(51), pp. 7488-7499. DOI: 10.1016/j.vaccine.2021.10.031. Full title and citation appear on the cover above.

Compare the replies

Open a checker. Return and paste. Keep the reply with your discussion.



1. Open: At Check, open the recorded findings. Both checkers and results boxes are visible in **External checks**, in the Evidence box.
2. Paste: On returning from a service, paste its full reply into **SynthID results** or **OpenAI results**. Your text is kept immediately; no upload back into SDA or extra save form is needed.
3. Keep: Download session notes before changing examples, reloading or closing the page.

1 Which file or part of the item does the reply cover?

2 What does it add to the source and model findings?

3 What would we include when sharing our interpretation?

Use the agreed prepared example. For documents, select a page or slide image for SynthID and paste with the same material selected. The OpenAI shortcut is enabled for image examples only. A separately checked image reply can name its page or frame in the OpenAI box.

Replies are session notes, separate from the recorded model scores. SDA does not independently confirm the submitted file or service response. Keep an error message as returned; a skipped check can leave its box empty. The one-page participant sheet gives the full workflow.

USING THIS GUIDE

7

Make it your session

Before the group arrives

Open the local recorded demo on the intended device and screen. Use prepared examples agreed for the session. Choose from the prepared examples, test sound or the presentation's slide controls, and try a session download. Keep a saved copy of this guide available.

Keep participation flexible

Offer time to look or listen, think quietly, talk in pairs or respond aloud. People can pass and revisit a response. Agree what, if anything, the facilitator will record outside the app.

Choose the pace together

A short session can follow one example through all four activities. A longer workshop can compare AI-generated and traditional media. The same questions can support discussion before and after opening the saved findings.

Working with external checks

The Evidence box shows SynthID Detector and the OpenAI image checker together. Google or OpenAI receives the file or image chosen there, including retained metadata, under that service's account, current terms and any charges, separately from SDA's API accounts. Opening a link sends no media. Check access and current file limits in advance; offer a facilitator demonstration or previously recorded reply as an alternative.

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Credits and scope

Screenshots: SDA Vision workshop journey (September 2026) and paired-checker demo (15 October 2026); sample responses for this guide. Opening illustration: Dr Sam Martin, Smart Data Research UK (UKRI) Fellow (Grant number UKRI4010), Manchester Metropolitan University (MMU), 2026; AI-generated artwork. Saved opening-image model analysis: 26 September 2026. Podcast text findings cover about 46% of the transcript; a separate Google Gemini description covers the first 20 seconds of sound. Built-in audio checks: AI-origin detection from the sound itself is outside this workflow. External watermark records have their own file and coverage.

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